

TURN INSPIRATION INTO ACTION

The WOOP Method for Student Leadership

A ready-to-run lesson for advisors to lead with their student leadership group after any event. Built for a 30 to 40 minute class period. Adjust it to fit your time.

OVERVIEW

GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

30 to 40 minutes

Grades 9 to 12

Advisor led

Any size group

Goal

Students will turn what they heard at an event into real action. They will reflect on what impacted them, build a personal plan for the next 30 days, and work together on a plan to improve their school or group.

Objectives

Students will be able to:

1. Reflect on the sessions and presenters they experienced and name the ONE takeaway that impacted them most.
2. Use the WOOP method (Wish, Outcome, Obstacle, Plan) to set a personal goal for the next 30 days.
3. Connect their takeaway to an issue or opportunity at their school and agree on ONE focus as a group.
4. Build a group action plan with clear steps, who is responsible, and a check-in date.

What you need

- A list of every session, workshop, and speaker your students saw
- The WOOP worksheet, one per student ([download it here](#))
- Pens, sticky notes, and chart paper
- A spot to post the group's action plan

AT A GLANCE

THE 40 MINUTES

Feel free to adapt this to fit your time.

3 min • Open

Quick check-in.

7 min • Step 1

Reflect and find the ONE thing.

8 min • Step 2

WOOP for you, then share.

8 min • Step 3

Switch to school. Find ONE focus.

10 min • Step 4

School WOOP and action plan.

4 min • Close

Say the plan out loud.

LESSON PLAN

STEP BY STEP

3 MIN
OPEN

Check in

Go around the room: what's one word for how you left the event?

"We're not here to talk about everything we learned. We're here to pick ONE thing and actually do something with it."

7 MIN
STEP 1

1

Reflect on everything

Put the list of sessions and presenters where everyone can see it. Students can reflect any way that works for your group: writing, partners, small groups, or a gallery walk. The point is for students to share their thoughts, ideas, and opinions on each session and presenter, then land on the ONE thing that stuck with them most.

- What resonated with you?
- What sat with you?
- What left an imprint?

By the end of this step: every student has named their ONE thing.

Want more? Use the [reflection questions](#) below. Push past the first answer. It's usually the one they think an adult wants to hear.

Using their ONE thing, each student builds a WOOP for one change they'll make in their personal life in the next 30 days. Read each question out loud and give them time to write.

W: Wish

Based on what stood out to you, what did it make you want to come true in your life?

Big enough to matter, small enough to start.

"I want to stop comparing myself to people online."

O: Outcome

What would it look like if it happened? How would you feel?

Get specific. Picture it.

"I'd feel more confident and actually sleep instead of scrolling at night."

O: Obstacle

What really gets in the way?

Look inside first. A habit, a feeling, a thought. Be honest.

"When I'm bored or stressed, I grab my phone without thinking."

P: Plan

What's ONE action you'll take? Make it an if/then.

If my obstacle shows up, then I will...

"If I catch myself scrolling after 10, then I'll put my phone across the room and text a friend instead."

Then share and reflect

Students share their ONE thing, why it stuck with them, and their plan. Pairs, small groups, or a few volunteers to the whole room. Whatever works for your group.

- What's your ONE thing?
- Why did it stick with you?
- What's your plan?

Now switch: from personal to school

8 MIN
STEP 3

3

Find the school focus

Based on their biggest takeaway, students look at their school. Each student shares their ONE thing and why it stuck, this time as it relates to their school. Then the group answers:

"What's ONE issue or opportunity at our school that came up most?"

Write the answers on chart paper. Pick one as a room, or let each group run with their own.

By the end of this step: your group has ONE school focus. That's the wish for Step 4.

10 MIN
STEP 4

4

WOOP for the school, then make it an action plan

Same four questions, now as a team. Do this one together, out loud.

- **W:** What do we want to improve or change? "Every student feels like they belong."
- **O:** What would it look like if it happened? "Nobody eats lunch alone. New students know people by week two."
- **O:** What gets in the way at our school? "We stick to our own friend groups and don't notice who's left out."
- **P:** What's ONE action we'll take in the next 30 days? "Start a lunch buddy table."

Turn the plan into action

A plan without names and dates stays a wish. Fill this out together before anyone leaves.

Action step	Who	By when	How we'll know it worked
<i>Ask admin for a table and a Friday time slot</i>	<i>Ana</i>	<i>This Wednesday</i>	<i>We have a yes and a spot</i>
<i>Make a flyer and announce it</i>	<i>Marcus and Jay</i>	<i>Next Monday</i>	<i>It's on the morning announcements</i>
<i>Run the first lunch buddy table</i>	<i>Whole council</i>	<i>Next Friday</i>	<i>10 or more students join in the first month</i>

Set a check-in date on the calendar before you close.

4 MIN
CLOSE

Say it out loud

Each student reads their personal plan to a partner. Saying it to someone makes it real. Post the school action plan where everyone will see it.

"Now the question is: what will you do with it?"

Keep the momentum

Debrief fast

Run this within 48 hours of any event, while it's still fresh.

Keep it visible

Post the WOOPs in your room. Put the action plan on your meeting agenda.

Check in

At 1 week and 30 days: What worked? What got in the way? What's the next step?

Facilitator tips

- Keep everyone moving. Partners, small groups, standing up. Nobody needs to sit for 40 minutes.
- Nobody has to share anything personal. Offer a pass every time.
- If a group wants to change everything, ask: "If we could only do ONE, which one?"
- Model it. Share your own WOOP first. It gives students permission to be honest.
- Celebrate the small stuff at your check-ins. One action done beats ten planned.